

Games & Fun Pack • Songs, Chants and Movement Breaks

Games and Fun

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

FIELD COPY



PLATE I. The Hackles crew, drawn from life: Hackle (1) and the six friends who look after each strand.

Hackles • a free kit • quillsup.org

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials: CC BY-NC 4.0 (free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit). The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]



CONTENTS

Contents

Teacher Quick Start (one page, print and keep) 4

How to use this section 5

1. The Hackles Up Chant 7

2. The Passphrase Rap 7

3. Tell, Tell, Tell Someone 9

4. Pause Palm Freeze (movement break) 11

5. Pause, Check, Tell (a round) 12

6. The SPOT Cheer 13

7. Share or Shell 13

8. Oops Is Okay 15

9. The Ladder Climb (movement break) 16

10. The FLAGS Flow 17

Bonus: Quick cheers, transitions and calm-downs 19

Make it your own 19

Teacher notes on tunes (copyright) 19

Accessibility variants (all pieces) 21

Printables checklist (print and cut exactly this) 21

[Logo: Hackles]

SONGS, CHANTS, RHYMES AND MOVEMENT BREAKS

Ten original pieces, each with lyrics, rhythm notes and motions

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

Hackles · a free kit · quillsup.org

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials: CC BY-NC 4.0 (free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit). The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]

No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

Teacher Quick Start (one page, print and keep)

What it is: ten short pieces (chants, a rap, songs, a round, a cheer, two movement breaks, a spoken-word groove) that put the Hackles routine in the body. Each takes 1 to 3 minutes. No instruments, no recordings.

IF YOU HAVE...	DO THIS PIECE	BANDS
1 minute, any time	1. The Hackles Up Chant (or a Bonus cheer from the table at the end)	K-5 (plain spoken version for 6-12)
2 minutes, a restless class	9. The Ladder Climb (standing or seated)	K-8
3 minutes, a wiggly class	4. Pause Palm Freeze	K-5
2 minutes, a passwords lesson	2. The Passphrase Rap	3-8 (K-2: Silly Words Hop)
2 minutes, telling or Help Ladder lesson	3. Tell, Tell, Tell Someone	K-2 (3-5 as a round)
2 minutes, privacy lesson	7. Share or Shell	K-2
2 minutes, scams lesson	6. The SPOT Cheer (3-5) or 10. The FLAGS Flow (6-12)	3-5 / 6-12
2 minutes, review of the routine	5. Pause, Check, Tell (a round)	3-8
1.5 minutes, after an Oops lesson	8. Oops Is Okay	K-5

How to teach any piece (3 steps, 3 minutes): 1) Say it in rhythm with the motions; children echo line by line. 2) Add the beat (clap, pat, stomp or desk-tap). 3) Add the tune or speed it up. Never ask a child to sing alone.

If...

- **A child covers their ears or the room gets too loud:** switch to the **whisper version** or the **silent version** (motions only); offer a quiet corner.
- **A child cannot do a motion:** every piece has a seated or small version; any motion can be done with just a hand, a head nod or a tap.
- **A child says "I don't want to sing":** they can clap, tap, or watch. Never force it.
- **Teens groan:** good. Deadpan delivery, let them add verses, keep it fictional.

Never: put these words on a pop-song tune (those are copyrighted), record a child's name with their voice, or use a real password as a lyric.

How to use this section

Music puts a skill in the body. A child who has sung "Tell, tell, tell someone" forty times has the Tell step ready at the exact moment they will need it. Every piece here is **original lyrics**. Where the lyrics sit on an existing tune, the tune is a **public-domain** melody and is **flagged** with **[PD TUNE]** so you know. Everything else uses **original rhythms** you can clap, stomp or tap on a desk. No instruments are needed. No recordings are needed. If you are not a singer, say the words in rhythm; it works just as well (and is funnier).

QUICK INDEX

#	TITLE	TYPE	BANDS	LESSON LINK	TUNE / RHYTHM
1	The Hackles Up Chant	Call-and-response chant with motions	K-5 (works as 6-8 opener)	All lessons	Original clap rhythm
2	The Passphrase Rap	Rap with a beat	3-8 (K-2 spoken lite)	Passwords L2	Original 4/4 beat
3	Tell, Tell, Tell Someone	Song	K-2 (3-5 round)	L1 Tell-Someone Team/Ladder	Twinkle, Twinkle [PD TUNE]
4	Pause Palm Freeze	Movement break (freeze dance)	K-5	L3 Pause and Ask	Any music or a drum/clap
5	Pause, Check, Tell (a round)	Round	3-8	Hackles routine	Row, Row, Row Your Boat [PD TUNE]
6	The SPOT Cheer	Cheer	3-5	L3 Scam Spotters	Original stomp-clap
7	Share or Shell	Song with motions	K-2	L5 Private vs. Public	Frère Jacques [PD TUNE]
8	Oops Is Okay	Rhyme with motions	K-2, 3-5	L4 Oops Button; L10 Oops Recovery	Original rhyme, no tune
9	The Ladder Climb	Movement break	K-8	L1 Ladder; Next-Rung Rule	Counting + marching beat
10	The FLAGS Flow	Spoken-word beat	6-12	L3 Phish Lab; FLAGS	Original groove (slow 4/4)

HOW TO TEACH A NEW PIECE (3 STEPS)

1. **Say it first**, in rhythm, with the motions, no tune. Children echo line by line.
2. **Add the beat** (clap, pat, stomp, or desk-tap).
3. **Add the tune** (only if it uses a PD tune) or **speed it up** for fun.

SAFETY, KINDNESS AND ACCESS (FOR ALL PIECES)

- **Everyone can join in any way.** Motions have a **seated** or **small** version. For Deaf and hard-of-hearing students, use big motions and written words on a poster; students can sign (see Lily's "help" sign in K-2 materials [VERIFY with a Deaf educator]) or tap the beat on a desk so everyone can feel it.
- **Never ask a child to sing alone.** Group only.
- **Noise control:** every piece has a "**whisper version**" (do it all in a whisper; very funny).
- **No sad or scary lyrics.** No songs mention hurt or fear; they mention noticing, pausing, checking and telling.
- **PD tune flag:** melodies marked **[PD TUNE]** are traditional/public-domain melodies in the U.S. as best we know. Lyrics here are original. [VERIFY tune status for your country; the **words** are ours.]
- **Rhythm notation used:** **CLAP** = clap, **PAT** = pat knees, **STOMP** = stomp, / = a beat of silence, **(R)** = rest. "1 2 3 4" count in. All pieces are in 4/4 unless stated.

1 The Hackles Up Chant

Type: Call-and-response chant with motions. **Bands:** K-5 (and a cool-cat version for 6-8). **Time:** 1 minute. **Lesson link:** every lesson (the opener or closer).

Learning goal: Remember the four-step routine and its motions in order.

Rhythm: Steady **4/4 walking beat**. Teacher says the call on beats 1 to 4; the class says the response on the next 4 beats. Count in: "1, 2, 3, 4."

Lyrics (Teacher / Class):

TEACHER (CALL)	CLASS (RESPONSE)	MOTION
"When something online feels odd to me..."	"HACKLES UP!"	Hand brushes up the back of the neck, fingers spreading like spikes.
"Then I..."	"PAUSE!"	Pause Palm: flat hand like a stop sign.
"And then I..."	"CHECK!"	Fingers to eyes (K-2) or circle fingers like a magnifying glass (3-5).
"And I always..."	"TELL!"	Hand on heart, then reach out.
"A false alarm?"	"IT'S FINE!"	Shrug and grin, both hands out.
"Is it ever my fault?"	"NEVER, EVER!"	Shake head, big sweeping "no" arms.
"Trust your..."	"HACKLES!"	Both hands pop up behind the head, fingers spread like quills.

Say it in all the ways (fun variations):

- **Whisper version** (all in a whisper, tiptoe motions).
- **Robot version** (stiff arms, flat voice: "HACK-LES UP").
- **Opera version** (dramatic arms, big voice, and a tiny "oooh" on the pop).
- **Slow-motion version** (everything at half speed, like a dream).
- **Silent version** (motions only; teaches the signals).

Tips: Use as a signal during other lessons: when you say "Hackles up?" they answer "Pause, Check, Tell!" and do the motions. It becomes the class's shared "pause button."

6-8 / 9-12 note: Use the plain, **spoken** version: "Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell." with the hand signals optional. No tune. Teens can do it deadpan; that is funny, too.

2 The Passphrase Rap

Type: Rap. **Bands:** 3-8 (K-2 can do the "Silly Words Hop" lite version below). **Time:** 2 minutes. **Lesson link:** 3-5 L2 Passphrase Lab; 6-8 L2 Account Defense; K-2 L2 Secret Passwords.

Learning goal: A good passphrase is long, random, silly, and secret; one per account; share only with a trusted adult.

Rhythm: Steady **boom-clap beat** at about 90 beats per minute. **Beat pattern (one bar):** STOMP (1), CLAP (2), STOMP (3), CLAP (4). Rap the words on the beat; each line is 4 beats. Count in: "1, 2, 3, 4, drop it."

Lyrics:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 1
Verse 1 Short little password? That's a flop! (STOMP clap STOMP clap) A thief can guess it before you stop. (STOMP clap STOMP clap) Four weird words, now watch me go: (STOMP clap STOMP clap) Pickle! Giraffe! Trombone! Yo-yo! (STOMP clap STOMP clap) Chorus (everybody) Long! (CLAP) Silly! (CLAP) Secret! (CLAP) Strong! (CLAP) Weird words, big lock, nothing wrong! Long! (CLAP) Silly! (CLAP) Secret! (CLAP) Strong! (CLAP) A thief would guess it all night long! Verse 2 Not my birthday, not my dog's name, (STOMP clap STOMP clap) Not the same one in every game. (STOMP clap STOMP clap) One per door, that's the rule I keep, (STOMP clap STOMP clap) So if one's stolen, the rest still sleep. (STOMP clap STOMP clap) Chorus Verse 3 Friend says, "Lend me your password, please?" (STOMP clap STOMP clap) I say, "Nope! Not for cookies or cheese!" (STOMP clap STOMP clap) Only me and a grown-up I trust, (STOMP clap STOMP clap) Hackles up! Pause! Check! (CLAP clap clap) And that's a must!	

Outro

Long, silly, secret... (*whisper*) strong.

Motions: Verse 1: lock a pretend padlock with a click. Chorus: four finger-up counts (one finger for each word: Long, Silly, Secret, Strong). Verse 2: wag a finger "not this, not that". Verse 3: hold up a Pause Palm, then Tell Wave.

K-2 "Silly Words Hop" (lite): Teacher says three silly words ("purple... banana... trumpet!"). Class hops three times, repeats the words in a whisper, and puts a finger to their lips: "Shhh, it's secret!"

6-8 / 9-12 "Remix": Remove the "silly" jokes, add: *"One per account, manager on the side. Passkey's got my back, got no place to hide."* [VERIFY wording on passkeys with the L2 lesson] and *"Two-step on, I'm not afraid. Check the real app, I'm not scared."*

Seated version: pat knees and clap; skip stomps.

TEACHER TIPS

*If your class laughs at "yo-yo!", lean into it; the silliest words get remembered. Keep real passwords off the board. Ask for a **new four-word silly phrase** from each team (not a real password), and remind them that a phrase the whole class has heard is no longer secret. (Playtest note: the first draft's chorus said "my passphrase is a very silly song", which contradicted the rule "not a song or a quote". Fixed.)*

3 Tell, Tell, Tell Someone

Type: Song. **Bands:** K-2 (3-5 can sing it as a round, or in a deep voice for fun). **Time:** 1.5 minutes. **Lesson link:** K-2 L1 My Tell-Someone Team; 3-5 L1 The Help Ladder.

Learning goal: Telling a trusted grown-up is the strongest move, and it is never my fault.

Tune: "Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star" [PD TUNE] (traditional French melody, public domain as far as we know [VERIFY for your country]). Lyrics below are original. Sing "Twinkle" slowly, or speak it in rhythm.

Lyrics:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 2
Verse 1	

Tell, tell, tell someone you trust, (hand on heart, reach out)
Hush the worry, hush the fuss! (hands wave the worry away)
When I feel a tingly start, (brush the back of the neck)
Hand on heart, I do my part. (hand on heart)
Tell, tell, tell someone you trust,
Hush the worry, hush the fuss!

Verse 2

It's not tattling, it's not shame, (shake head)
It is never, ever blame! (big "no" arms)
If I click or tap too quick, (oops hands)
I can tell, and that's the trick! (point to a trusted grown-up)
Tell, tell, tell someone you trust,
Hush the worry, hush the fuss!

Verse 3 (Trusted Hand verse)

Count your helpers on one hand, (hold up one hand)
Grown-ups who will understand. (wiggle each finger)
One at home and one at school, (point left, point right)
Telling is a super tool! (tap hand)
Tell, tell, tell someone you trust,
Hush the worry, hush the fuss!

Motions: Tell Wave on "Tell, tell, tell"; hold up fingers on Verse 3.

3-5 Round: Divide the class into three groups. Group 1 begins Verse 1; when they reach "Hand on heart, I do my part," Group 2 begins. Group 3 begins after Group 2 reaches the same line. Everyone stops when they finish the last line. (Use only if the class can hold a tune; otherwise speak it in rhythm.)

Silly version: Sing each line in a different voice (squeaky mouse, rumbly bear, pirate).

Teacher notes: Use at the end of the Tell-Someone lesson and before a disclosure-heavy lesson. After the song say the sentence: "I need help with something online." Verse 3 says "count your helpers on one hand": some children have only one or two trusted grown-ups, and that is fine.

Say "as many as you have" and let them hold up as many fingers as they like. (*Syllable check: every line is 7 syllables, matching the tune.*)

4 Pause Palm Freeze (movement break)

Type: Freeze dance. **Bands:** K-5. **Time:** 3 minutes. **Lesson link:** K-2 L3 Pause and Ask; 3-5 L3 Scam Spotters.

Learning goal: Practice the Pause on cue, even when something is tempting (a "Gifty offer").

Needs: Music (anything you like) or just a drum/clap; the teacher voices "Gifty."

How to play:

1. Play music. Children dance, wiggle, spin or walk (seated: arms and shoulders only).
2. When the music stops, **Gifty (the teacher in a silly voice)** shouts an offer: "FREE COINS! TAP THE BOX!"
3. Children freeze, show the **Pause Palm**, and shout: "**Hackles up! No thanks, Gifty!**"
4. Gifty groans: "Aw, shucks!" Music starts again.

Gifty offers (silly, never scary): "Free ponies! Free pizza! A free spaceship! Just tap and don't tell anyone!" "Everybody wins a hat! A hat made of cheese!" "I'm a very official pop-up! You have 47 problems!"

Rules: Nobody is out for moving. If someone wobbles, "Oh, a wobble! That is called a false alarm. Keep dancing!" **No elimination.**

Variation for 3-5: Gifty names a **SPOT letter** in the offer ("Only 5 seconds left! That's a P!") and kids call it out: "P for Pressure!"

Quiet version: Do it in slow motion with no music; freeze when the teacher raises a hand.

Visual cue (for Deaf, hard of hearing or sound-sensitive children): when the music stops, the teacher also holds up a big paper hand (the Pause Palm sign). Never use flashing lights. Gifty's voice should be silly, not loud.

Gifty is always an adult. Children may suggest silly offers ("a hat made of cheese") but never voice Gifty.

Seated version: Move arms; freeze arms.

5 Pause, Check, Tell (a round)

Type: Round (everyone sings the same line, starting at different times).

Bands: 3-8. **Time:** 2 minutes. **Lesson link:** the Hackles routine, any lesson.

Learning goal: Remember the steps in order.

Tune: "Row, Row, Row Your Boat" [PD TUNE] (1852, public domain in the U.S. [VERIFY for your country]). Lyrics are original.

Lyrics:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 3
Hackles up, pause, check, tell, Someone you can trust. Pause-check-tell, pause-check-tell, pause-check-tell, pause-check-tell, Hackles up, hooray!	

(Syllable check against "Row, Row, Row Your Boat": 6 - 5 - 12 - 5, the same as the original. The first draft's third line had only 8 syllables and its first line put "Pause" before "Hackles up"; both fixed so the words come in routine order.)

How to sing the round: Divide into 3 groups (or 4 in a bigger class).

Group 1 starts. When Group 1 gets to "Someone you can trust," Group 2 starts. Then Group 3. Everyone ends when they finish the last line.

Easier: sing it all together as a unison song, then in a round after a few days.

Motions: Hackles Up (neck brush) on "Hackles up," Pause Palm on "pause," magnifier circle on "check," Tell Wave on "tell."

6-8 variation: "Whisper round": each group whispers, one at a time, moving the whisper around the room like a wave.

Teacher notes: If a class cannot hold a round, do **call-and-echo**: teacher sings a line, the class echoes.

6 The SPOT Cheer

Type: Cheer with a stomp-clap rhythm. **Bands:** 3-5. **Time:** 1 minute.

Lesson link: 3-5 L3 Scam Spotters; 3-5 L8 Real or Fake?

Learning goal: Remember SPOT: Secret, Pressure, Offer too good to be true, Trick to move you.

Rhythm: STOMP-STOMP-CLAP (rest) repeated, a steady original pattern.

Cheer:

Field note

No. 4

Teacher: "Give me an S!" Class: "SECRET!" (hand over mouth, a "shh" sign)

Teacher: "Give me a P!" Class: "PRESSURE!" (point to a pretend watch, tap it fast)

Teacher: "Give me an O!" Class: "OFFER TOO GOOD!" (arms wide as if holding a giant prize)

Teacher: "Give me a T!" Class: "TRICK TO MOVE YOU!" (a "click" finger)

Teacher: "What's it spell?" Class: "SPOT!" (point at the teacher)

Teacher: "What do we do?" Class: "PAUSE! CHECK! TELL!" (three signals)

All: "Hackles up!" (hands pop on the head)

Variations:

- **Speed round:** do the whole cheer in 10 seconds.
- **Reverse:** the class calls and the teacher answers, making mistakes on purpose (the class corrects!).
- **Scoring game:** the teacher reads a card; the class does the cheer motion for each letter they find.

Seated version: all motions at desk height, stomp with fingertips.

7 Share or Shell

Type: Song with motions. **Bands:** K-2. **Time:** 2 minutes. **Lesson link:** K-2 L5 Private vs. Public. Pairs with the read-aloud "Pip Picks a Shell."

Learning goal: Sort what is fun to share from what is private.

Tune: "Frère Jacques" [PD TUNE] (traditional, public domain [VERIFY for your country]). Lyrics are original. Sing it with **two voices:** Teacher sings line A, class echoes the second line.

Lyrics (each line is sung twice, just like the original; the syllable counts now match: 4 - 3 - 6 - 3): (*The first draft's second lines had 4 or 5 syllables and the third line of Verse 3 had 5, so they did not fit the tune.*)

Field note

No. 5

Verse 1 (the "share" verse)

Pip is asking, Pip is asking,
Share or shell? Share or shell?
Color, song, and smile, yay! Color, song, and smile, yay!
Share, share, share! Share, share, share!

Verse 2 (the "shell" verse)

Pip is asking, Pip is asking,
Your address? Your address?
Password, house, and phone, no! Password, house, and phone, no!
Shell, shell, shell! Shell, shell, shell!

Verse 3 (the "hmm" verse)

Pip is asking, Pip is asking,
My own name? My own name?
Let me ask a grown-up, let me ask a grown-up,
Hmm, hmm, hmm! Hmm, hmm, hmm!

Motions: "Share": open hands wide. "Shell": curl up with arms around knees (or arms in a circle in front of the chest, seated).

Game version ("Share or Shell"): Teacher calls items: **my favorite animal (share), my phone number (shell), my smile (share), my home address (shell), my name (hmm! ask a grown-up what to share), my**

school (shell). Children do the motions. When an item is "hmm", everyone does **Check Eyes** and says "Ask a grown-up!"

Teacher note: Keep the items simple. Do not ask children to share their real address or other private info "as an example."

8 Oops Is Okay

Type: Rhyme with motions (no tune needed; it also works as a call-and-echo). **Bands:** K-2, 3-5 (used with the OOPS card). **Time:** 1.5 minutes. **Lesson link:** K-2 L4 The Oops Button; 3-5 L10 Oops Recovery.

Learning goal: Mistakes are normal; recovery has steps; telling helps.

Rhythm: Steady 4/4 **bounce**, clap on 2 and 4.

Rhyme:

Field note

No. 6

Oops, oops, we all make 'em!

Robots, bears, and grown-ups too! (point to the Crew posters)

O: Oh, I'm okay. (open both hands) Breathe in, breathe out. (breathe)

O: Off and out. (hands push away) Close it, clap! (clap)

P: People help. (hand on heart, reach out) Tell someone you trust!

S: Secure it! (turn a pretend key) Click! That's the end of the oops.

Oops, oops, we all make 'em!

Telling makes it right for you!

Add-on for K-2: shorten the OOPS card to **O (okay)**, **O (off)**, **P (people)**, then **S (secure it)** only if the grown-up helps.

Echo version: Teacher says each line; class echoes.

Silly extension: "Fixit's Two Left Shoes": invent a silly oops (two left shoes, a fish in the bathtub, pudding in the backpack) and practice saying "I made an oops, I need help!" in silly voices. It lowers the shame around mistakes. (*Safety: the first draft used "a sock in the toaster"; children copy what is funny, and putting things in a toaster is dangerous, so it was replaced everywhere in the pack.*)

Teacher notes: After the rhyme, ask: "What do you say when someone tells you about their oops?" "**Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's fix it together.**"

9 The Ladder Climb (movement break)

Type: Counting and marching movement break. **Bands:** K-8. **Time:** 2 minutes. **Lesson link:** K-2 L1; 3-5 L1 Ladder; 6-8 L1 Help Ladder and the Next-Rung Rule.

Learning goal: The Help Ladder has rungs; if the first person doesn't help, keep climbing.

Needs: Space to stand; a floor ladder (four pieces of masking tape) is optional.

How to play:

1. Everyone stands and "climbs" an invisible ladder with hand-over-hand motions on the rungs: **1 You (Pause) / 2 A friend / 3 A trusted adult / 4 A reporting channel** (3-5 can use three rungs).
2. Teacher says a scenario. Kids climb one rung at a time, saying the sentence out loud:
 - **Rung 1 (Pause):** "I'm pausing."
 - **Rung 2 (friend):** "Will you come with me while I tell someone?"
 - **Rung 3 (trusted adult):** "I need help with something online."
 - **Rung 4 (reporting channel):** "I'm using the report button."
3. Teacher plays the **Rung-2 friend who says "ignore it."** The class must say: "**Next rung!**" and climb to Rung 3.
4. At the top: everyone does the Tell Wave and cheers: "**I told someone!**"

Counting chant (for K-2):

<i>Field note</i>	No. 7
One, two, three! (climb) Climb, climb, climb with me! (climb) If the first one doesn't help, (shake head) Next rung! Next rung! (climb) Tell, tell, tell! (Tell Wave)	

Seated version: climb with arms, tap fingers on the desk for each rung.

Variation for 6-8: Teams take turns acting as "the person who doesn't help"; the climbers practice staying calm and saying "I'm not done yet. Thanks. I'm going to ask someone else too." That is the Next-Rung Rule out loud.

Teacher note: The "doesn't help" role is played by the teacher or a volunteer reading a card. Keep it kind: "I'm busy, later," not unkind.

10 The FLAGS Flow

Type: Spoken-word groove (slow, deadpan). **Bands:** 6-12. **Time:** 2 minutes. **Lesson link:** 6-8 L3 Phish Lab (FLAGS); 9-12 L3 Social Engineering Case Lab.

Learning goal: Recall FLAGS: Fast, Login ask, Amazing offer, Gotta keep it secret, Strange sender or link; and the second-channel check.

Rhythm: Slow **4/4 groove**, about 80 beats per minute; finger-snaps on 2 and 4, soft foot-tap on 1 and 3. Count in with a laid-back "one, two, three, four." The voice stays **cool and flat**; the humor is in the deadpan.

Lyrics:

Field note

No. 8

Intro: (snap snap) Check it. Check it.

F: It says "act fast," (snap) says "right now." (snap)
If it's rushing me, I'm slowing down. (snap) Pause.

L: It wants my login. (snap) Wants my code. (snap)
Real support won't ask me that. (snap) Nope.

A: "You've won a prize!" (snap) "A hundred dollars!" (snap)
I didn't enter. (snap) Luck is not that lucky.

G: "Keep it quiet." (snap) "Don't tell a soul." (snap)
Secrets plus pressure? (snap) Hackles up, I'm gone.

S: Strange sender. (snap) Strange link. (snap)
If I can't verify it (snap)... I will not click.

Hook: (all) F. L. A. G. S.
Fast. Login. Amazing. Gotta keep it secret. Strange.

Check it twice, then ask a trusted human.

Outro: (snap snap) Second channel. (snap) Open the app myself.

Second channel. (snap) Ask someone I know.

That's FLAGS. (mic-drop motion: open hand, drop it)

9-12 remix line: *"Who gains if I act in the next five minutes? That's the question that I'm asking."*

Motions: For each letter, hold up the corresponding number of fingers (F=1, L=2, A=3, G=4, S=5).

TEACHER TIPS

Teens often groan, then know it by heart. Let them add verses (they will add funnier ones). Keep everything fictional. Keep the vibe respectful and understated; the humor is in the deadpan delivery.

Seated version: snap and tap fingers.

Bonus: Quick cheers, transitions and calm-downs

Use these 10-second moves to start, switch or end an activity.

NAME	WHAT TO SAY AND DO	WHEN TO USE
Hackles Pop	Teacher: "Hackles..." Class: hands pop up on the head, "UP!"	Getting attention.
Pause Palm Wave	Teacher raises a Pause Palm. The class sees it and raises theirs, silent, one by one, like a ripple.	Quiet cue.
Tell Wave	Hand on heart, reach out, "Tell!"	Ending a lesson.
Peeper's Peek	Fingers form circles around eyes. "HMMMMM!"	Starting a Check activity.
Ember's Warm Breath (calm-down)	Hands cupped as if holding a small flame; breathe in for 4, out for 6; "Warm in, soft out."	After a hard conversation; Ember's screen-balance break.
Fixit's Fix	Mime tightening a bolt: "Click, click, fixed!"	After an Oops.
Gifty Goodbye	Wave at an imaginary box: "Bye-bye, Gifty!"	Ending a game.
Good Grown-up Reply	Class says together: "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's figure it out together."	After any Tell practice.

Make it your own

- **Add a local verse.** Replace "pickle, giraffe, trombone, yo-yo" with your school mascot or class pet (never a real password).
- **Translate.** Sing it in your students' home languages; the motions are universal.
- **Let kids write a verse.** Offer the rhyme "Pause, check, tell" and let them add one line (kind, silly, and about noticing or telling).
- **Record it.** If you make a class recording, use first names only or just voices, and follow your school's policy on student audio/video [VERIFY]. Never post a child's name and voice together.
- **Hackles Day:** use these as station intros and parade chants (see 09).

Teacher notes on tunes (copyright)

TUNE USED	STATUS (AS WE UNDERSTAND IT)	NOTE
Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star	Traditional melody (18th century French song "Ah! vous dirai-je, maman"), public domain in the U.S. and most countries [VERIFY]	Original lyrics only.
Row, Row, Row Your Boat	Published 1852; public domain in the U.S. [VERIFY for other countries]	Original lyrics only.
Frère Jacques	Traditional French round, public domain [VERIFY]	Original lyrics only.
All other pieces	Original rhythms and lyrics created for Hackles	CC BY-NC 4.0 [VERIFY with counsel].

Do not substitute lyrics onto modern pop songs; they are copyrighted. If you want a new tune, use a public-domain one such as "Skip to My Lou" or "Yankee Doodle" [PD TUNE; VERIFY].

Accessibility variants (all pieces)

NEED	WHAT TO DO
Color-vision difference	Nothing in these pieces depends on color. Lyric posters use bold black text on white with a different icon for each verse.
Low vision / blind	Teach by ear and echo; keep motions large and name them aloud ("Pause Palm: flat hand"); lyric posters in large print (at least 36 pt).
Deaf or hard of hearing	Big motions; lyric posters; a drum or desk tap that can be felt ; the Pause Palm sign held up as a visual cue; students may sign (Lily's "help" sign appears in K-2 materials [VERIFY with a Deaf educator]).
Dyslexia / reading difficulty	Learn by echo, not by reading. Posters have a picture beside each verse.
English language learners	Chants are short and repeat; motions carry the meaning. Invite home-language versions of the chant. Teach "hackles up, pause, check, tell" as four words with four signals.
Motor / mobility	Every piece has a seated or small version (arms, hands, fingers, head, or just eyes and a smile). Stomp = fingertip tap.
Sensory / noise sensitive	Use the whisper or silent version. Never use flashing lights. Keep a quiet corner and Pass cards. Drums at low volume; no sudden loud claps.
Anxiety about singing	Group only, never solo; clap or tap instead of singing; any child may be the "beat keeper."
Cultural / language fit	Songs use public-domain tunes that may be unfamiliar outside the U.S. and Europe. Say the words in rhythm instead of singing, or use a local tune you know is free to use [VERIFY].

Printables checklist (print and cut exactly this)

Art comes from the art team. Reference these files in

[kit/09_Art/characters/](#) (do not edit them). Gifty appears in Piece 4 and the Bonus table: **[ART REQUEST: Gifty art is not yet in [characters/](#); ask the art team for [gifty.png](#)]**.

#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
1	Hackles Up Chant poster (the table: call / response / motion)	1 poster (A3 or 2 pages taped)	None	hackle_up.png
2	Passphrase Rap lyric poster (verses and chorus in large type)	1 poster	None	latch.png
3	Tell, Tell, Tell Someone lyric poster + Trusted Hand drawing	1 poster + 1 hand outline per child	None	buddy.png
4	Pause, Check, Tell round poster (4 lines, 4 motions)	1 poster	None	peeper.png (check)
5	SPOT Cheer poster (S, P, O, T with motions)	1 poster	None	peeper.png
6	Share or Shell poster (3 verses + share/shell pictures)	1 poster	None	pip.png

#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
7	Oops Is Okay poster (O, O, P, S with motions)	1 poster	None	fixit.png
8	FLAGS Flow poster (F, L, A, G, S with finger counts)	1 poster	None	icon only: kit/09_Art/icon_spot_it.png
9	Gifty offer cards for Pause Palm Freeze	8 cards (offers listed in Piece 4), one offer each	Cut	Gifty [ART REQUEST]
10	Pause Palm sign (a big paper hand on a stick)	1	Cut and tape to a stick	hackle_helping.png
11	Floor ladder (Ladder Climb)	4 pieces of masking tape, 1 m each	Tape on floor	none
12	Bonus cheer table (Hackles Pop, Pause Palm Wave, Tell Wave, Peeper's Peek, Ember's Warm Breath, Fixit's Fix, Gifty Goodbye, Good Grown-up Reply)	1 sheet	Post by the door	kindle.png , fixit.png

Cut list: 8 Gifty offer cards. Everything else is posters and tape.